



Republic of the Philippines
Department of Agriculture
BUREAU OF FISHERIES AND AQUATIC RESOURCES
REGIONAL FISHERIES LABORATORY XII
J. Catolico St., Lagao, General Santos City

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Document Code: WI-01-CHE-01	SAMPLE PREPARATION		

Introduction

This document provides a standard procedure to ensure laboratory samples taken from the whole sample submitted are of homogeneous quality. This procedure is applicable to fish and fishery products submitted for Chemical Analysis to the Regional Fisheries Laboratory XII.

1. Responsibilities

1. Laboratory Analyst
2. Technical Manager
3. Quality Assurance Manager
4. Customer Service Officer

2. Procedure

2.1 Sample Preparation

A. Histamine

1. Fresh Raw Samples

- a. Using a scalpel or knife, take the muscle tissues of the sample ensuring that heads, tails, bones, scales and internal organs of the fish are not included.
- b. Finely chop the muscle tissue samples using a knife and a chopping board, or grind in blender or homogenizer or food grinder.
- c. Collect the sample in a small beaker or pan.

2. Frozen Raw samples

- a. Thaw the samples completely.
- b. Throw away thaw drippings.
- c. Proceed as (2.1,1)

Prepared by:

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Quality Assurance Manager

Reviewed and Approved by:

EUGENE GAY B. JAMORA
Laboratory Manager



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3. Products Packed in Medium (that maybe or is normally used by the consumer)

- Open the packaging container
- Transfer the entire contents in a homogenizer or blender
- Homogenize or blend until the mixture is homogenous.
- Collect the sample in a clean beaker.

4. Products Packed in water, Brine or Similar Medium (that is normally discarded by the consumer)

- Open the packaging container
- Discard or drain the liquid medium using a sieve.
- Transfer the samples retained by the sieve in a homogenizer or blender.
- Homogenize or blend until the mixture is homogenous.
- Collect the sample in a clean beaker.

5. Processed products containing no separable liquid.

- Thaw the sample inside the package if it is frozen.
- Transfer the contents in a blender or homogenizer.
- Homogenize or blend until the mixture is homogenous.
- Collect the sample in a clean beaker.

B. Moisture

1. Frozen Raw Samples

- Keep the sample frozen inside the freezer if not yet to be analyzed.
- Thaw the sample thoroughly at ambient conditions.
- Decant thaw drippings.
- With a scissor and forcep, randomly cut muscle samples from the batch.
- Mince/Chop the randomly cut muscle samples.
- Place the sample in a beaker for analysis.

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2. Dried Samples

- Keep the sample in a designated dry area (dessicator cabinet).
- With a scissor and forcep, randomly cut muscle samples from the batch.
- Mince/Chop the randomly cut muscle samples.
- Place the sample in a beaker or pan for analysis.

3. Document History

Revision No.	Issue Date	Original Entry	Revised as	Recall Date

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